Before that, he served as the Ambassador of India to the United States of America during the Obama Administration from 2013 to 2015. He moved there from China, where he was the longest serving Indian Ambassador, from 2009 to 2013. His other ambassadorial positions are those to Singapore from 2007 to 2009 and to the Czech Republic from 2000 to 2004.

Earlier diplomatic assignments included those in Moscow, Washington DC and Colombo as a Political Officer, Budapest as a Commercial Counsellor and Tokyo as the Deputy Chief of Mission. In the Ministry of External Affairs, he was the Head of the Americas Division from 2004 to 2007 and Director of the East Europe Division from 1993 to 1994. He also served as the Press Secretary to the President of India from 1994 to 1996.

After his diplomatic career, he was President (Global Corporate Affairs) at Tata Sons Private Limited during 2018-19.

Dr S. Jaishankar is a graduate of St Stephen’s College at the University of Delhi. He has an MA in Political Science and an MPhil and PhD in International Relations on nuclear diplomacy from Jawaharlal Nehru University, Delhi.

He was a recipient of the Padma Shri award in 2019.